A-A-0053029 (DM)
5 August 1987

INTERIM COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

KNIFE, GENERAL SURGICAL (Disposable)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Interim Commercial Item Description which was developed by the Defense Personnel Support Center, Directorate of Medical Materiel, DPSC-RST, 2800 South 20th Street, Philadelphia, PA, 19101, based upon currently available technical information.

This interim commercial item description covers two general surgical knives.

Type I shall have a blade of commercial designation number 10.

Type II shall have a blade of commercial designation number 20.

Salient characteristics:

General. The knife shall have a stainless blade with protective guard, plastic handle, be sterile and disposable and suitable for routine surgical use.

Material. The blade shall be fabricated of a suitable martensitic corrosion-resistant steel, type 440 or similar, in accordance with ASTM F899.

The handle shall be fabricated of a rigid plastic, such as Acrylonitrile-butadiene-styrene (ABS) or similar, that will not bend or break during use.

Hardness. After the blade is properly hardened and tempered, the Rockwell hardness of the finished blade shall be C50 to C57 when tested according to the blade hardness test.

Finish. The blade cutting edge shall be uniform, well defined and sharp. All edges of the blade shall be smooth and free of any nicks, burrs, jags, pits, grind marks, signs of corrosions, or any other defects.

The handle shall have a smooth finish except for the gripping area, which shall be serrated or textured.

AMSC N/A FSC 6515

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Style, design and dimension. The design and dimensions of the knife shall comply with Figure 1.

Identification marking. Each blade shall be permanently and legibly marked with its commercial designation number. The blade shall bear the manufacturer's name or registered trademark and the word "stainless". Both blade and handle of foreign manufacture shall bear the name of the country of manufacture.

Sterility. The knife shall be sterile, free form pyrogens and have a minimum SAL of 1×10^{-6}.

Workmanship. The knife shall be pre-assembled with the blade securely attached to the handle. Both blade and handle shall have sufficient stiffness not to deflect sideways beyond the torque limits under conditions of normal use.

Product Quality Level.

Visual and dimensional examination. Shall be examined to verify that design, construction and workmanship are in accordance with applicable requirements.

Material. The supplier shall be responsible for performing tests to assure that materials are in accordance with requirements specified.

Unit. Package (PG). One package containing one hundred knives of type I or ten knives of type II each knife individually packaged sterile, as specified, constitutes one unit. The individual package shall be a sealed, peel open type container capable of maintaining sterility of contents unless package is damaged or opened.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

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Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

Sampling for examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, and as indicated in Table I. Unit of product for examination purposes shall be one knife.

Table I. Sampling For Inspection

Type of defect	Inspection level	AQL (percent defective)
Major	II	1.0
Minor	II	4.0

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TABLE II. Classification Of Defects

Categories	Defects
Critical	None defined.
Major	
101	Knife not free from cracks, pits, burs, sharp edges, scale, rough areas or corrosion.
102	Style and design not as specified.
Minor	
201	Identification markings not present, not complete, not correct, or not legible.
202	Cutting edge and point not central and uniform.

Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as specified below. The unit of product for test purposes shall be one knife.

Characteristic	Requirement	Test procedures	Inspection level	AQL
Hardness test	Reqmts	ASTM E18 E92 E140	S-2	1.0
Dimensions	Reqmts	------	S-1	2.5
Performance	Reqmts	Reqmts	S-2	1.0

Test.

Hardness. Hardness of the blade shall be tested in accordance with ASTM E18 or E92. Conversions shall be in accordance with ASTM E140. Hardness impressions shall be taken as close to the cutting edge as possible, but not on beveled portions. The average of three readings shall be considered the hardness of the blade.

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